

BEARDED TIT

The Bearded Tit forms a single-species family, the Panuridae. A reedbed specialist, it eats insects in summer and hardens its stomach in winter to digest reed seeds.

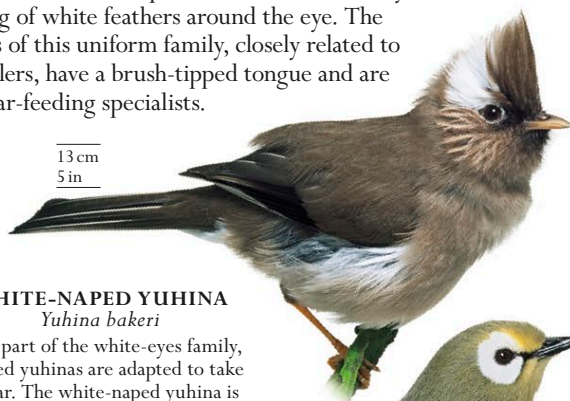


16–17 cm
6½ in

BEARDED TIT
Panurus biarmicus

WHITE-EYES

Most of the Zosteropidae are characterized by a ring of white feathers around the eye. The birds of this uniform family, closely related to babblers, have a brush-tipped tongue and are nectar-feeding specialists.



13 cm
5 in

WHITE-NAPED YUHINA
Yuhina bakeri

Now part of the white-eyes family, crested yuhinas are adapted to take nectar. The white-naped yuhina is an eastern Himalayan species.

BROAD-RINGED WHITE-EYE

Zosterops polioastrus

This open woodland white-eye is restricted to isolated mountain ranges in Ethiopia, Kenya, and Tanzania. Distinct races are found according to region.



11 cm
4¼ in

FAIRY-BLUEBIRDS

Two species of fairy-bluebirds, from the family Irenidae, are found in Southeast Asia, where they feed on fruits – especially figs – in forest canopies. Only males have a vivid blue colour; females are dull green.



bright blue
upper parts

25 cm
10 in

ASIAN FAIRY-BLUEBIRD
Irena puella

The most widespread fairy-bluebird, found from India to Indonesia, this species often feeds with other fruit-eaters, such as hornbills and pigeons.

GOLDCRESTS

Among the smallest of passerines, these colour-crested birds of the family Regulidae are found in cool northern forests. They have a high metabolic rate, which forces them to feed constantly when awake. They glean tiny, soft-bodied invertebrates from foliage with their needle-like bill.



9 cm
3½ in

GOLDCREST
Regulus regulus

All kinglets are adapted to coniferous forests. The Eurasian goldcrest has especially grooved feet and enlarged toe-pads for clinging to needle-like leaves.



11 cm
4½ in

RUBY-CROWNED KINGLET
Regulus calendula

The red head patch of this N. American species is visible when it raises its crown feathers – a trait shared by all kinglets.

NUTHATCHES AND RELATIVES

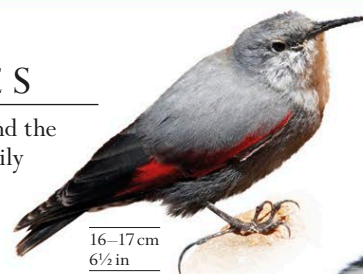
Nuthatches, in the family Sittidae, and the wallcreeper, sole member of the family Tichodromidae, are more acrobatic than treecreepers, and do not use their tail as a support. They feed on seeds as well as insects, sometimes hoarding them in crevices.



14 cm
5½ in

EURASIAN NUTHATCH
Sitta europaea

A widespread species, this forest bird can – like other nuthatches – crack open nuts by wedging them in cracks in tree bark.



16–17 cm
6½ in

WALLCREEPER
Tichodroma muraria

This central Eurasian mountain bird gleans insects from rocks with its pointed bill.



black stripe across eye

11 cm
4¼ in

RED-BREASTED NUTHATCH
Sitta canadensis

This N. American species has a similar body pattern to the Eurasian species, but males are more vividly coloured.

orange-brown
underparts

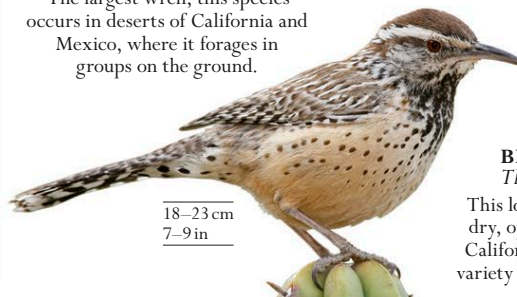
WRENS

With the exception of the winter wren, the family Troglodytidae is confined to the Americas. Most species are highly vocal, but visually inconspicuous, short-winged birds that forage on insects in undergrowth; some even sleep on the ground.

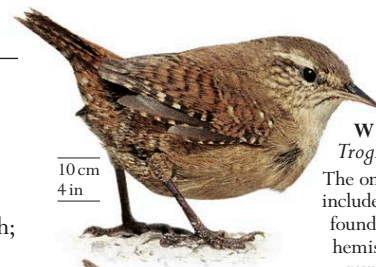
CACTUS WREN

Campylorhynchus brunneicapillus

The largest wren, this species occurs in deserts of California and Mexico, where it forages in groups on the ground.



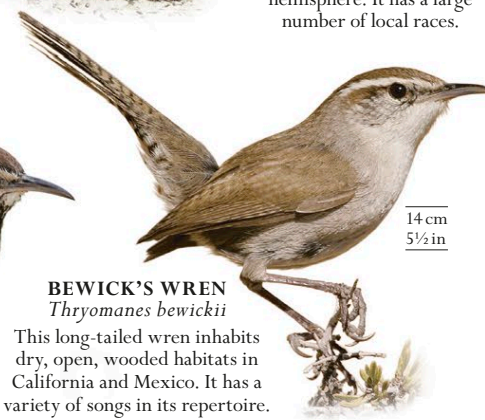
18–23 cm
7–9 in



10 cm
4 in

WINTER WREN
Troglodytes troglodytes

The only wren whose range includes Eurasia, this bird is found across the northern hemisphere. It has a large number of local races.



14 cm
5½ in

BEWICK'S WREN
Thryomanes bewickii

This long-tailed wren inhabits dry, open, wooded habitats in California and Mexico. It has a variety of songs in its repertoire.